

Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board

15 May 2019

WDID: 5A520105001

Mike Murphy
Gerber-Las Flores CSD
331 San Benito Avenue
Gerber, CA 96035

PERMIT CONTINUANCE, GERBER-LAS FLORES WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY, WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS ORDER 93-033, TEHAMA COUNTY

The Gerber-Las Flores Wastewater Treatment Facility (Facility) is owned and operated by the Gerber-Las Flores Community Services District (Discharger). The Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board (Central Valley Water Board) regulates wastewater discharges from the Facility under Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) Order 93-033, adopted on 26 February 1993. This WDRs Order had been scheduled to be reviewed for renewal or update on 26 February 2015.

Central Valley Water Board Staff inspected the Facility on 18 January 2018 and performed a case file review. The Facility has a history of maintaining compliance with WDRs Order 93-033, is well designed, and properly maintained and operated. Additionally, the Facility has not made changes to the wastewater treatment and disposal system since the adoption of WDRs Order 93-033.

As such, the Central Valley Water Board conducted a permit continuance review of the Facility's WDRs Order 93-033. Details of Staff's review is provided in the attached Technical Memorandum and Continuance Checklist. Based on staff recommendations the Central Valley Water Board has administratively extended the WDRs Order renewal date to 15 May 2029 or until other regulatory permit coverage is available.

The Central Valley Water Board is currently drafting a General Order for large wastewater treatment facilities that discharge between 100,000 gallons per day and 1 million gallons per day. This General Order is expected to be adopted in the next few years. The Facility would likely be eligible for enrollment into this General Order.

Currently, the Facility does not perform groundwater monitoring. It is likely that the Facility may have to implement a groundwater monitoring program, which would include the installation of a network of groundwater monitoring wells as part of any future revisions or amendments to the Facility's current WDRs Order.

Additionally, staff will amend under a separate cover the current Monitoring and Reporting Program associated with WDRs Order 93-033 to maintain consistency with current monitoring requirements.

If you have any questions, please contact me by phone at (530) 224-6130, by email at Valerie.Rasmussen@waterboards.ca.gov, or by mail at the footer address at the bottom of the previous page.

A handwritten signature in cursive script that reads "Valerie Rasmussen".

Valerie Rasmussen
Water Resource Control Engineer
Waste Discharge Requirements

VR: ch

Enclosures: Technical Memorandum
Continuance Checklist

Regional Water Quality Control Board
Region: 5R

Review/Update/Continuance Checklist

Purpose of this form: WDRs issued for the permitted discharge of waste to land do not by code expire. The CWC Section 13263 (e) states; "Upon application by any affected person, or on its own motion, the regional board may review and revise requirements. All requirements shall be reviewed periodically." This is different than waivers of WDR as cited in Section 13269 (a) (2) which states that "A waiver may not exceed five years in duration, but may be renewed by the state board or a regional board" Procedurally, the frequency of WDR review based on the facilities threat to water quality, as follows:

Threat to Water Quality	Review to Update or Continue Regulatory Coverage without Update
1	Every 5 years
2	Every 10 years
3	Every 15 years

*This form is intended to facilitate the required review. Staff should place a paper or electronic copy of the completed form into the facility's case file and update CIWQS accordingly (see the WDR Review Entry Process). This form pre-populates some information from CIWQS. Any changes to this form **are not** automatically transferred to CIWQS and must be done manually.*

WDID Number: 5A520105001
Discharger Name: Gerber-Las Flores CSD
Street: 331 San Benito Avenue
City/State: Gerber, California
Zip Code: 96035
Phone: 530-385-1005

Discharger Contact: Mike Murphy
Facility Name: Gerber STP
Street: Levee Road
City/State: Gerber, CA
Zip Code: 96035
Phone: 530-385-1904

Order #: 93-033 **Date Adopted:** 02/26/1993 **Scheduled Review Date:** 02/26/2015

Item	As In Current WDRs	Proposed Changes (if applicable)
Program	WDRMUNILRG	
Complexity	B	
Threat to Water Quality	2	
RB Staff	Valerie Rasmussen	
RB Author (if not same as staff)	None	

Most Recent Inspections: Displaying 3 of 7 Inspections completed since 02/26/1993

Date of Inspection	Type	Violations?	Summary
01/12/2018	Type B	No	Facility is well operated and maintained. No WDRs violations found.
12/07/2012	Type B	No	No areas of concern identified
03/06/2008	Type B	No	Conducted annual inspection of wastewater treatment plant. No violations noted. One area-of-concern: calibration of influent flow monitor. No discharge occurring to irrigation field. Adequate freeboard 2 ft on ponds.

Active Enforcement Actions: Displaying all Enforcements

Enforcement Action ID	Enf Action Type	Effective Date	Outstanding Milestones?

Update/Review Information

A. Date file review began: 4/1/2019

B. File Review (Check the applicable materials that were reviewed since last review)

- Waste Discharge Requirements ☒
- Correspondence ☒
- Inspection Reports ☒
- Monitoring Reports ☒
- Other Technical Reports ☒
- Review Policy Changes ☒
- Review CWQS Data ☒

C. Factors Affecting Revision/Rescission/Continuance

	Yes	No	N/A
1. Changes in waste type or quantity?		N	
2. Changes in treatment or disposal?		N	
3. Monitoring & reporting consistent with Board policy?	Y		
4. In compliance with waste discharge requirements?	Y		
5. Compliance with receiving water objectives	Y		
6. Compliance with Resolution 68-16?	Y		
7. Changes in Basin Plan?		N	
8. Changes in Federal/State water quality standards?		N	
9. Changes in Regional & State Board policy?		N	

10. Changes in land/facility ownership or operator?		N	
11. Changes in discharger responsibility?		N	
12. Discharger contacted/verified no changes to discharge	Y		
13. Region Specific Considerations:			

D. Recommendation

1. Recommended action (Check one)

☐ Revise☐ Rescind☒ No Action
Required

2. Recommendation Reasoning:

- The Facility has not changed wastewater operations since the adoption of current WDRs.
- Since the adoption of current WDRs the Facility has maintained permit compliance.
- The Facility is well designed and properly maintained and operated.
- A General Order for large wastewater treatment facilities that discharge between 100,000 gallons per day and 1 million gallons per day is in development and is expected to be adopted within the next few years. This Facility would likely be eligible for enrollment into this General Order.

E. Projected Date for Action or New Review Date: 5/15/2029

Date Review Completed: 5/15/2019

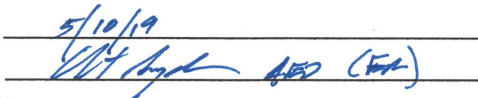
By: Valerie Rasmussen



Title: Water Resource Control Engineer

Date of Concurrence: 5/10/19

By: Patrick Pulupa



Title: Executive Officer

Revision/Rescission: Concurrence of Senior or higher needed

Continuance: Concurrence of Executive Officer needed

Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board

TECHNICAL MEMORANDUM

TO: George Low, P.G.
Senior Engineering Geologist

FROM: Valerie Rasmussen
Water Resource Control Engineer
Waste Discharge Requirements Unit

DATE: 15 May 2019

SIGNATURE: 

SUBJECT: PERMIT CONTINUANCE REVIEW, GERBER-LAS FLORES WASTEWATER TREATMENT FACILITY, WASTE DISCHARGE REQUIREMENTS ORDER 93-033, TEHAMA COUNTY

BACKGROUND AND SITE DESCRIPTION

The Gerber-Las Flores Wastewater Treatment Facility (Facility) is owned and operated by the Gerber-Las Flores Community Services District (Discharger). The Central Valley Regional Water Quality Control Board (Central Valley Water Board) regulates wastewater discharges from the Facility under Waste Discharge Requirements (WDRs) Order 93-033, adopted on 26 February 1993.

The Facility discharges up to 132,000 gallons per day of domestic wastewater from the communities of Gerber and Las Flores. The Facility is located less than a mile northeast of the Town of Gerber at 9470 E. Chard Avenue in Tehama County. There are approximately 375 households and one small commercial center in Gerber, and approximately 50 households in Las Flores that discharge into the Discharger's wastewater collection system and subsequently the Facility.

The Facility consists of headworks, a two-celled aeration basin with earthen construction and gunnite used for slope protection, two clay lined storage reservoirs, and an approximate 44-acre land application area (LAA) that surrounds the Facility, which is surrounded by orchards. The Facility irrigates the LAA yearly between May 15th- October 15th and is equipped with a tailwater return system, which captures any run off from the LAA and returns it to headworks. When irrigating, the Facility tests for BOD₅ and settleable solids and maintains effluent concentrations below the permitted limits of 60 mg/L for BOD₅ and 0.1 ml/L for settleable solids. The Facility uses the LAA as irrigated pastureland. Additionally, the LAA and Facility are secured from public access.

The Facility tests BOD₅ and total suspended solids (TSS) twice monthly from headworks and aeration basin effluent. Staff averaged the removal efficiency across the aeration basin using

data collected between 2008 and 2019. The Facility's average BOD₅ and TSS removal efficiency is approximately 72% and 75%, respectively.

Depth to groundwater is approximately 18-30 feet below ground surface and flows southeast towards the Sacramento River, which is located approximately one-mile east of the Facility. The nearest domestic well is located approximately 0.6-miles southwest of the Facility. The Facility currently does not perform groundwater monitoring; however, exceedances of water quality objectives is not expected to occur due to the design of the Facility.

DISCUSSION

Staff has performed a case file review and recommends issuing a continuance of WDRs Order 93-033 for the following reasons:

- The Facility has not changed wastewater operations since the adoption of current WDRs.
- Since the adoption of current WDRs the Facility has maintained permit compliance.
- The Facility is well designed and properly maintained and operated.
- A General Order for large wastewater treatment facilities that discharge between 100,000 gallons per day and 1 million gallons per day is in development and is expected to be adopted within the next few years. This Facility would likely be eligible for enrollment into this General Order.

Additionally, staff proposes to amend the current Monitoring and Reporting Program to be more consistent with current Monitoring and Reporting Programs.